



ARIZONA HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES FLOOR AMENDMENT EXPLANATION

57th Legislature, 2nd Regular Session

Majority Research Staff

HB 2601: Interstate 11; environmental; engineering; study

GRESS FLOOR AMENDMENT

1. Clarifies segmentation of the Interstate 11 project to be between *Interstate 10 at Casa Grande and Wickenburg as a segment of independent utility*, rather than between the border between this state and Nevada and Casa Grande.
2. Requires the Arizona Department of Transportation to carry out the environmental reviews and obtain any federal or state authorization required for the Interstate 11 segment, that follow federal law and the Federal Highway Administration's Guidance.
3. Modifies legislative findings.
4. Makes conforming changes.

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3/9/2026

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ADDITIONAL COW
GRESS FLOOR AMENDMENT
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES AMENDMENTS TO H.B. 2601
(Reference to House engrossed bill)

Amendment instruction key:

[GREEN UNDERLINING IN BRACKETS] indicates text added to statute or previously enacted session law.
[Green underlining in brackets] indicates text added to new session law or text restoring existing law.
[GREEN STRIKEOUT IN BRACKETS] indicates new text removed from statute or previously enacted session law.
[Green strikeout in brackets] indicates text removed from existing statute, previously enacted session law or new session law.
<<Green carets>> indicate a section added to the bill.
<<Green strikeout in carets>> indicates a section removed from the bill.

1 The bill as proposed to be amended is reprinted as follows:

2 Section 1. Title 28, chapter 20, article 1, Arizona Revised
3 Statutes, is amended by adding section 28-6902, to read:

4 28-6902. Interstate 11

5 A. NOT LATER THAN FOURTEEN DAYS AFTER THE EFFECTIVE DATE OF THIS
6 SECTION, THE DEPARTMENT SHALL FORMALLY REQUEST FROM THE FEDERAL HIGHWAY
7 ADMINISTRATION FOR SEGMENTATION OF THE INTERSTATE 11 PROJECT BETWEEN [THE
8 ~~BORDER BETWEEN THIS STATE AND NEVADA AND CASA GRANDE~~] [INTERSTATE 10 AT
9 THE CITY OF CASA GRANDE AND THE TOWN OF WICKENBURG AS A SEGMENT OF
10 INDEPENDENT UTILITY].

11 B. NOT LATER THAN THREE MONTHS AFTER FEDERAL APPROVAL OF
12 SEGMENTATION REQUESTED PURSUANT TO SUBSECTION A OF THIS SECTION, THE
13 DEPARTMENT SHALL [CONDUCT ANY TIER 2 ENVIRONMENTAL AND ENGINEERING STUDY
14 ~~THAT IS REQUIRED FOR CONSTRUCTION OF INTERSTATE 11~~] [CARRY OUT THE
15 ENVIRONMENTAL REVIEWS AND OBTAIN ANY FEDERAL OR STATE AUTHORIZATIONS THAT
16 ARE REQUIRED FOR THE SEGMENT DESCRIBED IN SUBSECTION A OF THIS SECTION.
17 CONSISTENT WITH APPLICABLE FEDERAL LAW AND THE FEDERAL HIGHWAY
18 ADMINISTRATION'S GUIDANCE].

19 Sec. 2. Legislative findings

20 The legislature finds that:

21 [1. A pending lawsuit should not stall the entire Interstate 11
22 corridor. In 2022, conservation and community groups filed a federal
23 lawsuit challenging the tier 1 environmental impact statement under the
24 national environmental policy act, alleging insufficient analysis of
25 impacts to sensitive desert lands and wildlife corridors in southern
26 Arizona.]

1 ~~[2.]~~ [1.] ~~[The lawsuit has unnecessarily frozen progress on the~~
2 ~~corridor]~~ [A 2022 lawsuit stalled the entire Interstate 11 project]
3 statewide, even in areas not directly implicated by the lawsuit, delaying
4 congestion relief, safety improvements and economic development.
5 ~~[3.]~~ [2.] Advancing the tier 2 study for the rest of the corridor
6 is a lawful and practical solution. This advancement demonstrates
7 independent utility, serves existing and projected transportation demand
8 and can function regardless of future decisions on southern alignments.
9 ~~[4.]~~ [3.] The rest of the corridor is environmentally distinct
10 from the contested portions of the corridor and does not raise the same
11 land-use or protected-resource concerns at issue in the lawsuit.
12 ~~[5.]~~ [4.] Segmenting the project is consistent with federal
13 highway administration precedent and long-standing national environmental
14 policy act practice, allowing discrete projects to advance when the
15 segments stand on separate merit.
16 ~~[6.]~~ [5.] Moving forward with tier 2 does not undermine the
17 ongoing litigation. It simply ensures this state can continue
18 responsible, incremental planning where legally permissible.
19 ~~[7.]~~ [6.] Interstate 11 is critical to Arizona's economic future,
20 improving freight movement, supporting regional growth, enhancing
21 interstate commerce and increasing safety for rapidly growing communities.

22 Enroll and engross to conform
23 Amend title to conform

MATT GRESS

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